

Tell Your *Story.*

Quick story worksheets for Vermont cheesemakers.

Don't try to write polished prose. Just give facts, fragments, memories, details. Use ordinary language. Messy is fine.

PICK ONE. CHECK THE BOX. THEN UPLOAD TO CLAUDE.AI. (You may need to create a free account)

☐

Fill out the worksheets by hand.

Take photos of every page. Upload them to claude.ai.

☐

Have Claude interview me instead.

Take a photo of *this page only*, upload it, and check this box.

☐

Record a voice memo answering the worksheet questions.

Take a photo of *this page*, upload it with the voice memo, and check this box.

FOR CLAUDE

Before helping me, read the Vermont Cheese Story Kit:

<https://github.com/adamjdavidson/vcc>

Use it as your guide. Then use my worksheet, photo, or voice memo as raw material.

You don't need to know your story yet. Just give Claude enough real material to work with.

Before you begin

About Your Business

1 Who needs to hear your story?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Consumers | ☐ Cheesemongers |
| ☐ Wholesalers / distributors | ☐ Restaurants & chefs |
| ☐ Press / media | ☐ Retailers (<i>grocery, specialty, co-op...</i>) |

☐ Other _____

2 Where do most people actually buy your cheese?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ At the creamery / on-farm store | ☐ Farmers markets |
| ☐ Cut-to-order cheese shops | ☐ Restaurants |
| ☐ Online, direct from us | ☐ Retailers (<i>grocery, specialty, co-op...</i>) |

☐ Other _____

3 What do you need to write?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Website copy | ☐ An info sheet for buyers and industry pros |
| ☐ A short elevator pitch (verbal) | ☐ A longer narrative for speeches, articles, or interviews |
| ☐ Label or shelf-tag copy | ☐ Social media captions |

☐ Other _____

Worksheet One

The Cheese Story

Use this page if you want to start with the cheese itself. Don't try to explain why it's special yet – just give concrete details.

1 What cheese are we talking about?

Cheese name.

2 In the plainest possible terms, what is it?

Milk type, style, age, format, rind, category, etc.

3 What animal milk is involved?

☐ Cow ☐ Goat ☐ Sheep ☐ Mixed milk ☐ Other

Anything specific about the milk or animals? *Breed, raw or pasteurized, single herd, seasonal milk, grass, hay, morning or evening milk.*

Worksheet One, continued

The Cheese Story

Pick up where you left off – or skip to whatever you actually have something to say about.

4 What cheese family or tradition does this belong to?

Alpine, cheddar, washed rind, bloomy rind, fresh goat, blue, tomme, Gouda-style, lactic, pasta filata, mixed milk, something else.

5 What other cheeses would someone compare it to?

Reference points, not exact matches. If you're not sure, write "not sure."

6 How do you make this cheese differently from other people?

Different milk, aging, rind treatment, cultures, timing, season, equipment, scale, tradition, handling.

Worksheet One, continued

The Cheese Story

Pick up where you left off – or skip to whatever you actually have something to say about.

7

What physically happens to make or age this cheese?

Ordinary language. *Washed every day, aged underground, cut small, stirred longer, wrapped in cloth, aged on boards, made only in one season.*

8

What do you usually say when you hand someone a sample?

The normal thing you actually say at a market table, tasting, shop, or event.

9

What do people often say when they taste it?

Actual remembered phrases are best.

Worksheet Two

The Maker Story

Use this page if you want to start with your own path into cheese. This isn't a full biography – only details that might help someone understand you, your work, or the cheese.

1 Who are you?

Your name and company name.

2 What were you doing before cheese, or before this cheese?

Job, farm work, family business, school, food work, dairy work, something else.

3 How did cheese pull you in?

Was there a person, place, animal, job, taste, accident, crisis, opportunity, obsession, or practical need?

Worksheet Two, continued

The Maker Story

Pick up where you left off – or skip to whatever you actually have something to say about.

4 What was hard about getting here?

Money, land, animals, regulation, learning the craft, finding customers, family, weather, mistakes, burnout, something else.

5 Who taught you, influenced you, helped you, or challenged you?

People, farms, cheesemakers, mentors, books, customers, mistakes, family, co-ops, buyers, animals, or anyone else.

6 What are you proudest of?

The cheese, the business, the farm, the animals, your team, your customers, or something you survived.

Worksheet Three

The Place Story

Farm · Creamery · Region

Use this page if you want to start with place: the farm, creamery, aging space, milk source, animals, town, county, region, or local history. Be as precise as you're comfortable being.

1 Where is the cheese made?

An actual physical address if appropriate. If not, the town, county, or region.

2 Where is the cheese aged?

Same place as where it's made? Different cave, cellar, facility, affineur, partner, or co-op?

3 Where does the milk come from?

Same farm? Neighboring farm? Specific herd or flock? Multiple farms? Town, county, or region?

Worksheet Three, continued

The Place Story

Pick up where you left off – or skip to whatever you actually have something to say about.

4 What animals provide the milk?

Species, breed if relevant, herd or flock size if useful, and anything concrete about how they're raised.

5 Who else is part of this place?

Family, employees, neighbors, milk suppliers, animal caretakers, affineurs, co-ops, local partners, longtime customers, or anyone else.

6 What's one thing someone would notice if they visited?

Something they might see, smell, hear, touch, or remember.
